Carolina Torreblanca

carolina-torreblanca.github.io
catba@sas.upenn.edu
Updated: 02/06/2026

Academic Appointments

University of Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Fellow, Penn's Development Research Initiative — August 2024-

University of Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Data Driven Discovery Initiative (DDDI) — July 2025-2026

Stanford University
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, PovGov Lab, Center for Democracy, Development & Rule of Law — Jan 2025-

Education

New York University — New York, NY
Ph.D. in Politics — 2019–2024
Committee: Tara Slough (chair), Arturas Rozenas, Pablo Querubín

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Mexico City, Mexico
B.A. in Political Science (honors) — 2010–2015

Instituto Tecnológico Autónomo de México — Mexico City, Mexico
B.A. in International Relations (honors) — 2010–2015

Research

Peer-Reviewed Articles

"Political Science Under Pressure: Competition and Collaboration in an Evolving Discipline, 2003-2023" (with Guy Grossman and Will Dinneen) — 2026
Perspectives on Politics, (forthcoming)

"Informal Connections Outweigh Co-authorship Ties in Academic Impact" (with Lluís Danús, Will Dinneen, Guy Grossman and Sandra González-Bailón) — 2026
PNAS, (forthcoming)

Under Review

"The Demobilizing Effect of Selective Exposure and Heterogeneous Responses to Violence" — 2026
Honorable Mention for the APSA Comparative Politics Section Sage Best Paper Award (2024)

"The Political Consequences of "Source Country" Operations: Evidence from Crop Eradication in Mexico" — 2026

"Class and the Development of Trust in Police in Latin America" (with Tara Slough) — 2026

"Reducing WhatsApp Usage to Mitigate Misinformation Exposure During Elections: Evidence from a Multi-Country Experiment" (with Rajeshwari Majumdar, Tiago Ventura, Shelley Liu, and Joshua A. Tucker) — 2026
R&R, American Journal of Political Science. Best Paper in Political Behavior Award, MPSA Annual Conference (2025)

"Democratic Participation without Democrats: Evidence from 109 Countries" (with Justin Melnick) — 2026

"The Credibility Revolution in Political Science" (with Guy Grossman, Yiqing Xu, and Will Dinneen) — 2026

Works in Progress

"Endogenous Information Consumption and Behavioral Changes"
(with Kun Heo and Elisa Wirsching) 2026

"Evaluating Scalable Approaches to Reducing Sexual Violence towards Children in Liberia"
(with Alex Hartman, Cecilia Mo, and Guy Grossman) 2026

Additional Experience

- Director of Data Analysis and Content, Data Cívica (NGO) 2017–2019

Teaching

- Lecturer, University of Pennsylvania Spring 2026
  Global Development: Intermediate Topics in Politics, Policy, and Data
- Co-Lecturer, University of Pennsylvania Spring 2025
  Global Development: Intermediate Topics in Politics, Policy, and Data
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Fall 2023
  Comparative Politics (Undergraduate) for Prof. Rahsaan Maxwell
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Spring 2023
  Comparative Politics (Undergraduate) for Prof. Gwyneth McClendon
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Fall 2022
  Quantitative Methods III (Graduate) for Prof. Tara Slough
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Spring 2022
  Intro to Quantitative Political Analysis II (Graduate) for Prof. Gizem Acikgoz
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Fall 2021
  Intro to Quantitative Political Analysis I (Graduate) for Prof. Gizem Acikgoz
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Spring 2021
  Introduction to Research Methods for Politics (Undergraduate) for Prof. Anna Harvey
- Teaching Assistant, NYU Fall 2020
  Political Theory (Undergraduate) for Prof. Dimitri Landa

Selected Presentations

Invited Presentations

- University of Pennsylvania, Criminology Department, 2025
- University of Pennsylvania, Comparative Seminar, 2024
- Latin American Conference, Harvard; Festival Gabriel García Márquez, 2018

Conference Presentations

- NEWEPS 2025
- MPSA 2025
- Stanford Gender Violence Workshop, 2025
- APSA 2024, 2023, 2022
- Political Economy of Latin America (PELA), 2020

Scholarships and Awards

- Best Paper in Political Behavior Award, 2025 MPSA Annual Conference
- Honorable Mention, APSA Comparative Politics Section Sage Best Paper Award (2024)
- 2024-2025 Dean's Dissertation Fellowship (declined)
- NYU George Downs Prize, 2022, 2023
- NYU MacCracken Fellowship, 2019-2024
- NYU GSAS Ralph M. Cariello & Ilona Cariello Fellowship, 2019-2024

Grants

- Fund for Innovation in Development (FID)
  Reducing Sexual Violence and Human Trafficking Risks in Liberia ($360,000)

- IPA- Peace and Recovery Initiative 2025
  Edutainment and Refugee Integration: An Experiment on Radio Popularity in Kenya ($315,208)

External Grants and Fellowships

- Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Data Driven Discovery Initiative (DDDI), July 2025-2026
- Postdoctoral Research Fellow, PovGov Lab, Center for Democracy, Development & Rule of Law, Jan 2025-

Skills

- R, Python, Stan, Stata

Languages

- Spanish (native), English, German (proficient)